

## LANATRAVELMANAGERS

Going on a world trip is a massive dream for Australians and the complexity of planning such an adventure can be intimidating. This is when you need someone on your side to help with all the planning and be on call in case anything goes wrong. And believe me, a lot can go wrong.

Lana Kancik is an expert in this area and works with a company in Australia called TravelManagers.com.au. We are speaking with a very interesting guest at the moment. It's Lana Kancik, and Lana is one of the senior managers at TravelManagers.com.au. And Lana has a very good background. She is an ambassador for Cruise Line International Association, a Holland America Cruise Line specialist, Princess Cruises Academy, Royal Caribbean International Cruise Line specialist, an Abu Dhabi and Dubai specialist, Alaska certified expert.

I love New York specialist and a wellness travel specialist. Wow. Lana, welcome to the program.

Thank you, Jeff. Thank you for having me. And I'm honored to be here.

Lana, your introduction was very interesting and nice. And apart from that, I've got extensive background in travel industry, start from the very small company that worked in wholesale and now work for an absolutely amazing network of travel agents. The name of that is the TravelManagers of Australia.

That's been around for about 20 years. We are all a network of independent consultants that we work for basically around our own businesses. Well, that's an incredible background you have.

And I know you have what happens with you and the clients is that they contact you. And especially these days, the travel world is changing so much on a daily basis. And we all had travel agents in the past, but these days with everything online as well, it's so much easier to engage someone like yourself and put it all in your hands.

And I suppose, you know, if people are doing world trips like we're talking from Amsterdam back to Australia here, if someone's wanting to go to Europe, there is so much involved. The fact is that no one person who's an amateur traveler can possibly have all of the great connections and all the advantages that they would get going through someone like yourself. Absolutely.

You said it very well. And interesting part, you know, the first question that usually people ask me, how are you coping with everything being online and AI and everything? And the most interesting part that is people are coming more to use travel agents now much more than it used to be before a pre-corded. Because yes, online, you can do it yourself, but then you don't realize that your connection in transit somewhere in places between the continents are 36 hours instead of three hours.

Yes, you might save \$20 here and there, but then you arrive to a different airport and your cruise

ship terminal is in completely different city. Like people think that, for example, the European cruise, those Mediterranean cruises that depart Venice, they're not actually depart from Venice itself because Italian government actually banned all the cruise ships to come into Venice. They just prevent all these distractions and everything.

They actually departing from a very small town outside Venice. So this is wealth of knowledge that all of us, like in travel industry and people who've been around for many years and travel extensive and went to the hotels to inspect, to make sure that the clients are happy. You can't get that knowledge online.

Even if you watch TikTok or Facebook or whatever, it still doesn't tell you how many, for example, how many steps you need to take in a positana to get from the center of the positana from the restaurants to your hotel. You're not realizing that. That's why people like myself come handy and we are sort of one-stop shop.

You can start from the planning of your itinerary with every little bits and pieces and small details and everything. To finish with travel insurance, make sure that everything runs smoothly. The most important is for my clients and for all our clients that we are here for you 24-7 in case of an urgency, which unfortunately happens very often.

Just recently, a couple of days ago, it was a huge cyclone coming to Hong Kong and Vietnam, other places, and all the flights in Hong Kong were cancelled. So who's going to help you? Of course, the travel agent who is here for you all the time. Yes, that's a wonderful thing to have as backup because, like you say, it's very easy now to book flights and things, but that's only one part.

It's probably only booking the flight is only 10% of the trip. So much more to think about. And it's such a great thing to just hand it over to a specialist like yourself to help out, especially if you're a couple, you know, a lot of older couples from Australia that they want to do the whole world.

And I'm seeing a lot of them here in Amsterdam and they might base themselves in a city like Amsterdam or Paris or London. And it might be the first time they've been to Europe and it's so overwhelming, isn't it? What is available to them and you can really steer them through and give them a really great experience where they'll get to see all the good bits without wasting their time. Absolutely.

Give my recommendations to where to stay, what restaurant to visit, where to eat, if they own a budget or what public transport to use. And this is the best part of being in trouble with travel managers and being the part of the network. We actually connected to each other and we are not competitors.

We all work together and we can ask each other questions like, may the good four-star hotel in such a such place and it needs to be a boutique hotel and it needs to be a little gym. 10 people

would jump online and recommend some places that they stayed or the clients stayed and it was very enjoyable and it's highly recommended by other people. This is the wealth of knowledge as well that is all our about 600 travel managers bring together as one company and then we share it with each other.

Well, that's a great system when people do engage you with TravelManagers.com.au. Any of you that they have the not only you, they have 600 other managers as backup and information sources. So that's a tremendous system. Absolutely.

And for us as well, if you look, you're all humans, we might have made mistakes. You might not know a lot of things. Some people have been to like every country in the world.

I've only been to about 40. There are a bit of few countries that I haven't been, but we have a specialist who's specializing only, for example, in South America or only in Africa or only in some other places that we can reach out and ask for an environment. We also have a system.

We very much screen all our service providers, which is in the travel industry called suppliers. We are not using any Doji or suspicious companies or tour operators. We only work with the trusted tour operators and we have our own internal preferred supplies list, which is not necessarily well known as a service provider and trusted supplier that can get the spot on that list.

And then everyone can use them because they're very much going above and beyond to make our clients happy. We're talking with Lana Kanczyk on Travel Radio and she's from TravelManagers.com.au, a fantastic company in Australia, which plans holidays for people all over the world and Australia itself. Now, I did notice, and I want to mention one thing, Lana, that you are very much a cruise line specialist.

So if people want to cruise anywhere in the world, your background there is quite extensive. Yes, that's correct. And I am an ambassador of Cruise Line International Australia, which is CLIA.

And this year I'm going to participate in a master program, which I need to study for and become a cruise master. And yes, I try to learn as much as possible, learn something new, always try to attend all the cruise CLIA conference and other cruise inspections, and to make sure that I can recommend the right product for the right client. Yes, and cruising is getting bigger and bigger and especially these days because the cruise lines need passengers, don't they? So that the amount of deals that are on it is just incredible.

Absolutely. And that's why people like past companies as well, because like you said before, it's very easy just to go online and just to book the cruise and just to be driven by the money value or the deal was special. But you need to sort of qualify a client to suggest the right cruise company or the right product.

Because if it's a family or if it's a multi-generation family that wants to go on a cruise, then you

need to recommend something like a more fun cruise and more that has a kids club or has some activities like goal cards. Yes. Yes, they have a whole goal card racing thing on the ship, it's incredible.

Yes, ice skating cream and zip lining and people who wants to have a more quieter holidays or just they're not offered a recreation or they're more for destination. Yes, well, I'm based in Amsterdam with travel radio here and they go out every single day. And also the people who are joining those cruises here in Amsterdam usually get to spend a couple of days in Amsterdam either arriving here and just to look around before they get on their cruise.

And they're so excited. As you know, Amsterdam is such a beautiful city in Europe and I suppose you've been here a lot too. And your background a bit Lana, it sounds like you speak a few languages.

I know you have Russian and you do you have a few other languages that you speak as well. I was born in USSR. Unfortunately, this country doesn't exist anymore, maybe fortunately, you never know.

So yes, I do speak Russian. I do read, not drive, but do read and understand and can communicate in Ukrainian language. I obviously Bulgarian is very similar to us so we can understand and I before I came to Australia, I lived in Italy.

So I used to, you know, like the language when you're not used to, you're not using it, it's become like sort of that language. But I used to speak Italian as well. I still understand and I still can watch the movie.

But because I don't use it very often. So it's just if people speak very quickly, I would not get it. But can watch the Italian movie without subtitles.

So yeah. And now you're based in Sydney, which is a wonderful place to be. Sydney is such a beautiful city.

And if anyone wants to contact you, you're easy to contact via [travelmanagers.com.au](http://travelmanagers.com.au). If they do a slash on the end and put your name, which is Lana dot can check, which is L A N A dot K A N C H I K. It's easy to get to you. And as I say, if you are planning a trip anywhere in the world, unless you're traveling often and a lot of people don't travel often these days and when they do it, they do it big. They want to do everything because if you're leaving Australia, you might as well do the whole world, correct? And it's for someone like you to be their partner in this.

And like you say, you're on call 24 hours a day. It's fantastic. Yes, that's correct.

And they can contact me by to get on my web page. By my email, it's Lana dot can check at [travelmanagers.com.au](http://travelmanagers.com.au) or on my phone number. It's zero four one zero six nine nine eight five five on what's up as well.

I've got my Instagram account. I've got Facebook account. So I'm contactable from anywhere.

And just one last question, Lana. I always ask this for people I speak to. What is your favorite place in the world and why? I know there's a lot.

Yes, it's a look. The answer won't be simple. OK, for the culture, food, people and something interesting.

I would go to Europe for the relaxation and just how you say it in the industry drop and flop. I would go to Bali for skiing or something, even though that people think that Alps are better skiing places. I would go to Queenstown to New Zealand.

What what a selection. That is fantastic. You obviously have a great background in travel and you're highly recommended by travel radio across the world.

Lana Kancik from [travelmanagers.com.au](http://travelmanagers.com.au). It's been an absolute pleasure to speak to you on the program. We highly recommend the people getting in touch with you direct or or any of the managers at [travelmanagers.com.au](http://travelmanagers.com.au) if they can't contact you. But you preferably and and thank you so much, Lana, for being on the program.

It's been great speaking with you. Thank you very much for having me. Thank you.